- Snacks such as murukku, thattai and seedai and sweets such as ladoo can be made from ragi.
- Thinai is best suited for making adhirasam. It can also be used to make halwa, ven pongal, sweet pongal or curd rice.
- For pulav or biriyani, go for parboiled samai, kudthiravali or varagu.

2.5. Processing of cereals

1. Primary processing of cereals

The main purpose of primary processing of whole cereal grains is to separate the outer layers of the grain from the inner section. When the grain is milled to produce white flour, the germ and the bran are discarded. The milling process grinds and pounds the grains. The process used for milling each grain type is slightly different.

After milling of the grain, the products can be described in the following ways:

- **Wholegrain or wholemeal** products means the whole of the grain has been used that is the bran germ and endosperm. Because the oil component in the germ can go rancid after a time, wholemeal products can develop off flavours.
- **Refined** products refer to products made only from the endosperm (starch). The bran and germ are removed. Refined products have a longer shelf life but are nutritionally poor because they contain mostly carbohydrate.
- **Enriched** products have vitamins and minerals added, usually to give them similar nutritive properties to wholemeal products, but without the fibre content.
- **Flour** is the powdered form of the grain after grinding or milling.
- **Meal** is a more coarsely ground product than flour.
- ***Instant or quick-cook*** products have been cooked, or partially cooked, then dehydrated. When reconstituted they require very little preparation time. Examples include instant porridge, quick-cook rice and instant Asian style noodles.

2. Secondary processing of cereals

Secondary processing of cereals results in a variety of products. The main products are as follows:

- Breakfast cereal production may involve other processes such as rolling and baking to make flakes. Eg. Wheat flakes.
- Bread and other bakery items such as savoury crispbreads, sweet biscuits, cakes and pastries require the additional processes of sifting, mixing, kneading, proving and baking. Some breads and cakes are leavened with raising agents such as yeast and baking powder.
- Extruded snack foods — commercially produced using a dough or batter that is extruded and cooked into novelty shapes. Eg. macaroni.
- Pasta is formed from flour-based dough and formed into shapes by hand or machine.

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